



Fig. 2: SWOT report

development. So when a person starts using the kit, he or she thinks he or she cannot utilise the product properly, and hence does not upgrade the product. The individual is afraid of going to the second level of the product, and this is where the cycle breaks. Whereas, someone who finishes a project with a level one product moves on to level two, level three and so on."

Huge market, yet much more to target

India, one of the largest higher-education networks in the world, has a sizeable number of engineering colleges, polytechnics and training centres. This implies a huge market for educational kits in India. Even if we consider only 5000 engineering colleges and around 1000 students per college, we can easily say that there are a total of five million engineering students in the country.

Sixty per cent of them, that is, three million, are from mechanical, electrical

and computer-science streams. If we take 10 per cent (which is a very modest number) of this figure and assume that on average they spend ₹ 1000 every year on these kits, the market is worth ₹ 300 million.

We should not forget that while the education sector drives the educational and training products market, there are other derivatives, including government policies, training providers and hobbyists, that influence this market.

Balasubramaniam shares, "Other users to the industry are the relatively senior professionals from the corporate world. These professionals, who have been a part of this industry for 5 to 10 years (or even more in some cases), buy these products to try out the latest updates from the industry and upgrade their skill set."

"Another segment is the budding entrepreneurs—engineers who want to turn their ideas into a working sample or prototype. They use these products to test and present the functionality

to investors or venture capitalists," he adds.

Government policies, schemes and regulations

Interestingly, there is no specific guideline or policy laid down by the government for the training and the education products industry yet. But as M.N. Vidyashankar, president, IESA, says, "There are lots of them that relate to this industry." When closely observed, these either relate to the whole electronics industry in general, or to the skill development industry in particular.

One common notion to which all the industry experts agree to is that, we need some sort of initiative that can connect students to the products available today. They agree that the main buyers of this industry, that is, the students, are generally unaware of the products available in the market, and we need to take an initiative to bridge this gap.

Since skill development in the field of electronics is already amongst the most looked-after initiative from the prime minister's bag this year, we reached out to Vidyashankar to find out if there is something that has been happening at the government's end. He shared, "Under the guidance and vision of DeitY, IESA and some others, industry experts have joined hands to spread awareness amongst students to bridge the gap between academia and the industry. This initiative was started during the months of May-June this year from a university in Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, and about 12 colleges in Karnataka. The response was over-whelming. We are catching the students immediately after third semester, and we are also training the teachers. If you look at the best universities in the world, every hour of every lecture is backed by four hours of field work and lab work. While in Indian universities this ratio is not even 1:1. So we need to reverse this trend in India. We also took a log of whether industry, students and academia are